

Minh Tran

@ Contact us

for Infrastructure Software Engineer, Developer Platform at
Dropbox

Welcome to your Candidate Portal! 🙌 Here, you can track your progress, access interview prep materials, and find key details about upcoming interviews. We’re here to support you every step of the way.

What's next?

Your recruiting team is scheduling your next interview

Based on availability requested on Feb 3

[View availability](#)

-  Virtual Interviews
-  Recruiting Screen
-  Technical Screen
-  Interview Plan
-  >

Virtual Interview Overview

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Wrap-Up session.

In most cases, interviews will take place over two days, with progression to the second day being dependent on your performance during Day 1. **Please note that any use of AI, ChatGPT, etc. is prohibited during your interview panel, as we want to ensure a fair and authentic evaluation of your own knowledge, skills, and problem-solving abilities without external assistance.**

Virtual Interview Day 1

- Coding Interview
- Coding Interview
- Deep Dive

Virtual Interview Day 2

- All Around
- Architecture Interview
- Wrap Up

After you have completed your interviews, you can expect an update from your recruiter within 5 business days. Of course, don't hesitate to reach out sooner if anything comes up or you have any questions!

The Coding Interviews

You'll complete your coding interviews on CodeSignal using your personal laptop. The interviewer will share the link at the start of your session.

These interviews take a deeper dive into your core coding fundamentals, building on the earlier technical assessment. You can expect questions that are slightly more complex and will likely involve multithreading or concurrency. While prior experience with these topics isn't required, brushing up in advance can be helpful.

We'll focus on how clearly you write code, how well you reason through your approach, and your ability to assess performance and memory trade-offs. Strong explanations, thoughtful implementation, and an understanding of time and space complexity are key. To stay focused on problem solving, we recommend using a programming language you're highly comfortable with. Please confirm your language of choice is approved by your recruiter beforehand during your prep call.

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[Preparing for Your CodeSignal Interview as a Candidate](#)

To get a sense of what to expect, we also recommend reviewing this short demo video:

[Dropbox Coding Interview Demo](#)

While the demo isn't domain-specific, it offers a helpful look at the structure and flow of a typical Dropbox coding interview.

Interview Tips:

- Think out loud as you work—communication and collaboration are an important part of how we assess candidates.
- Start by describing your high-level approach before jumping into implementation. This helps the interviewer follow your logic and may lead to helpful nudges if you're heading in the wrong direction.
- Don't forget to test your solution when you're done.
- If you're looking to practice beforehand, resources like CareerCup, Project Euler, and Cracking the Coding Interview are highly recommended.

The Deep Dive Interview

Our interview process includes a one-hour technical deep dive into a project you've worked on. This interview gives us valuable insight into your past work—something we're always excited to learn more about! You'll get to choose which project you'd like to discuss. There's no need to prepare a formal presentation (in fact, we prefer that you don't), but you will need to share a summary of your deep dive topic in advance so we can forward it to the interviewer beforehand.

Check out this helpful [video](#) that outlines what to expect during the Deep Dive Interview at Dropbox!

Tips on how to pick a great project:

- Pick a project where you played a substantial role. While many great engineering projects are team efforts, we want to hear about the work you specifically contributed. Choose something that gives you the chance to highlight meaningful decisions and impact you had.
- Choose a complex, high-impact project. Ideally, this is a project that showcases your strongest contributions and problem-solving skills. Straightforward or hobby projects tend not to reflect the level of depth we're looking for. We're especially interested in efforts that involved challenging trade-offs, cross-team collaboration, or product-critical impact.

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- We encourage you to review the [Dropbox Engineering Career Frameworks](#) as you prepare. This resource can help you better structure your deep dive by highlighting the skills, behaviors, and impact we look for at different levels. Referencing the framework can guide how you present your project and ensure your discussion reflects the scope and depth expected for the role.
- Ideally, you can pick a project that has shipped. We'll be asking questions about the project's impact, so being able to discuss how it ended is helpful.
- Lastly, the project shouldn't be evergreen responsibilities. While it's important to do things like close out bugs, we're interested in discussing specific projects in this interview.

The All-Around Interview

This is our take on a behavioral-style interview and gives you a chance to reflect on past projects and share your impact. The majority of the interview will be focused on just one project, but we recommend having another project on deck to discuss as well. Many interviewers allow time toward the end of the interview to shift to another project just to ensure we give you a chance to discuss all facets of your experience. The focus is on your approach to leadership, ownership, decision making, and collaboration—not necessarily technical depth, which is covered in the Deep Dive. You'll discuss 1–2 projects that highlight how you've driven outcomes, worked through challenges, and contributed meaningfully to your team and organization. **While it is not required that you pick a project different than the one you picked for your Deep Dive interview, sometimes it's beneficial for us to get a sense of how you've contributed across *multiple* projects in different interviews.** That being said, it's totally your call - you know your work best!

We're interested in the decisions you made, the relationships you built, and how you approach working in a collaborative and inclusive environment. This is a chance to connect your experience to the [Dropbox Core Values](#) and show how you'd contribute to Dropbox beyond our codebase. These values offer a useful lens in framing your stories and can help you anticipate the kinds of themes we'll explore.

Preparation:

Take time to reflect on 1-2 recent projects that showcase your strengths, especially those where you demonstrated ownership or led key efforts. If you're earlier in your career, think about times when you acted with autonomy or took initiative.

Interview Tips:

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- Structure your stories around challenges, actions, and outcomes.
- It's okay to go deep on one project if it captures multiple aspects of leadership and collaboration.
- Be honest and reflective—your growth, decision-making, and communication are just as important as the end results.
- There are a lot of questions that the interviewer will ask, so please try to keep your responses to 1~2 minutes each.

The Architecture Interview

This interview focuses on system design and is meant to explore how you think through large-scale technical problems. You'll be asked to design a system to support a hypothetical product or system at scale.

We will be looking to understand your ability to break down complex problems, evaluate trade-offs, and propose scalable, reliable solutions. You can expect open-ended questions where you'll need to clarify scope, ask follow-ups, and adapt your design as new information is introduced.

Preparation:

Start with a high-level approach and gradually dive deeper. We recommend spending the first few minutes understanding the requirements and constraints. Reviewing system design fundamentals ahead of time—especially if you haven't done these types of interviews before—will set you up for success.

We recommend reviewing this [short demo video](#), which outlines the format and flow of a typical Dropbox system design session.

**This is not domain specific but gives insight on how to prepare and what the technical systems design interview will look like.*

Interview Tips:

- **Clarify the problem first.** The question will likely be open-ended. Ask follow-up questions to understand the goals, what's in scope, and what you can ignore.
- **Start simple, then go deeper.** Begin with a high-level overview of your system. Then, pick a few parts and explain them in more detail.
- **Use diagrams.** Drawings help show how your system works. Show how the parts connect, where data flows, and where things might break.
- *Tip: You can practice drawing on CodeSignal or with a simple whiteboard tool.*
- **Think about trade-offs.** There are usually multiple ways to solve a problem. Talk through the pros and cons of each. We care more about your thinking than getting the

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- **Consider scale.** What happens when the number of users grows a lot? Try to spot bottlenecks before the interviewer does—they'll be looking for them.
- **Be collaborative.** Treat the interview like a discussion. Ask questions, adjust your plan if needed, and explain your thinking clearly.

Practice resources: [HiredInTech](#), [System Design GitHub Repo](#), and mock interviews with diagram tools like CodeSignal's whiteboard feature.

The Wrap Up

This is an informal conversation with the hiring manager for the team you're being considered for. It's a chance to connect, share more about your background and interests, and get a deeper understanding of the team's work, culture, and direction.

While relaxed in tone, this session plays an important role in ensuring a strong mutual fit. The hiring manager may ask about your most recent work, what motivates you, and how your experience could complement the team. They'll also likely share more about the team's mission, current challenges, and what is expected from the team.

Preparation:

We recommend preparing specific questions in advance—especially around the role, collaboration, and the team's future roadmap. Not only will it show your interest in the position, but it will help you assess if the role is a good fit for what you're looking for.

Interview Tips:

- Be ready to speak briefly about your current or most recent projects and what excites you professionally.
- Ask about the team's vision, culture, and how success is measured.